

Interactive/Algorithmic Soundscape Performance

(INTERACTIVE MEDIA PROJECT/WORKSHOP 2 2025/6 SEM2)

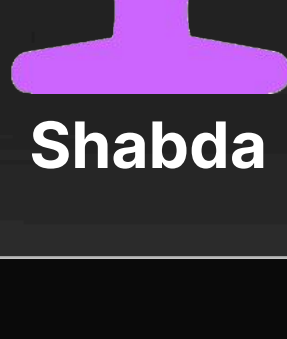


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- Module: CS6042 – INTERACTIVE MEDIA PROJECT/WORKSHOP 2 2025/6
- Semester: 2025/26 Sem 2
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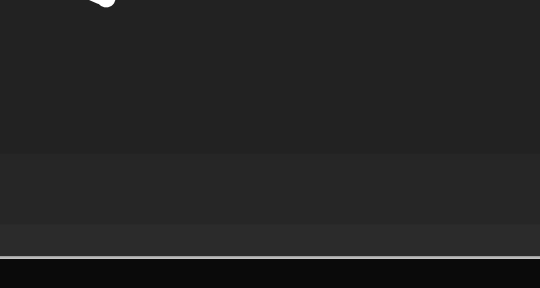
1. Rules of Performance:



Crossing Signals: From City Noise to Calm



Shabda



Tool I used to create music (Freesound Labs)

My Concept:

This performance explores the gradual transformation of an urban soundscape to a natural one. This interactive sound installation involves selecting sound samples via keyword searches and using rules to trigger these sound samples.

My Performance Structure:

This composition involves three main phases:
Urban - introduction of city sounds
Transition - movement into environmental sounds
Nature - calm natural sounds.

Keywords I Used:

- Urban sounds: traffic, footsteps, train, siren
- Nature sounds: birds, water, leaves, forest
- Transition sounds: rain, wind, night

Rules of the Performance:

- The performance begins with urban sound keywords.
- Two sounds of urban origins are played before transitioning to another keyword.
- Every third sound may be repeated.
- After approximately half the performance time, urban sounds will no longer be used.
- Transition sounds are played to ease the listener into the natural soundscape.
- The final section of the performance will consist of calm natural sounds.
- The performance ends with the last ambient sound playing for several seconds.

Duration of my Performance:

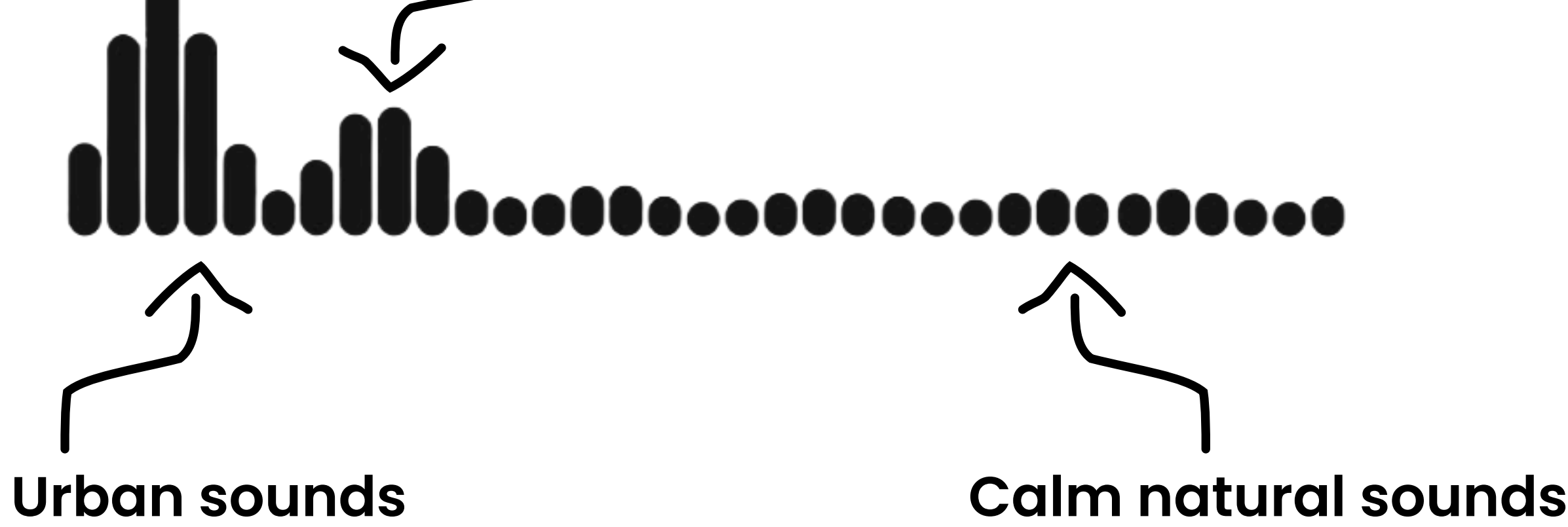
- Approximately 3 minutes.
(The performance was recorded using OBS screen recording software.)

2. Reflection: Crossing Signals – From City Noise to Calm

This project explores the use of the Shabda tool from Freesound Labs to create an interactive and algorithmic soundscape performance. The intention of this composition was to create a simple series of rules to govern the interaction between the performance and the algorithm. This composition does not create traditional musical compositions.

The choice of Shabda software allowed the users to search for and select sound samples from the Freesound database using keywords. This allowed for more interaction with the sounds that were selected. As opposed to programs that automatically create music, Shabda requires the user to choose keywords to play the samples.

The concept that led to the creation of this soundscape was the idea of transitioning from one type of sound environment to another. Cities are full of mechanical sounds such as traffic, footsteps, trains, and sirens. In contrast, natural environments are full of soft, spacious sounds such as wind, birds, water, and leaves. The main idea was to go from urban environments to natural environments.



To create this algorithm, I used a series of rules to decide on the different phases that would be included in this soundscape. The first phase would be the urban soundscape, where the keywords used would reflect that. The second would be a transition to environmental sounds such as rain and wind. The final phase would be a nature soundscape composed only of calm natural sounds.

Another rule created for this composition was to play multiple sounds from the same category before moving to the next keyword. Additionally, every third sound would be played again to create a sense of repetition within the soundscape. These rules allowed for a gradual development of the soundscape.

One of the more interesting aspects of creating this soundscape is that it does not require complex programming. Instead, it uses a series of rules to create an interactive soundscape. The limitations of the software, such as the short length of sound samples, also encouraged improvisation.

In creating this algorithmic soundscape, it becomes clear that simple rules and interactive elements can be used to create an interesting soundscape. Additionally, the fact that such a shift from urban to natural environments can be used to elicit such a reflective reaction from the audience is fascinating. The sounds used in the performance were retrieved from the Freesound database through the Shabda interface.

My Portfolio link:

<https://pranit1625.github.io/firstportfolio/>

THE END